collected and lastly, notice would be provided to each individual about where their data was being used.[15] The data input would be encrypted and non-downloadable, ensuring minimum amount of threat to the possibility of hacking. With these principles in place, the final product was created with four interfaces. The first is the citizen interface, the dashboard which individuals would be able to view in order to register for vaccinations. The vaccinator interface would be available for hospitals and vaccination centres both public and private, in which they would be able to upload information on vaccine stocks and vaccination capacities. The third interface would publish updated lists of vaccination centres along with timetables on a real-time basis. The last interface would once again be a citizen interface for individuals to download QR-coded vaccination certificates. When domestic travel opened up after the first wave, RT-PCR negative test reports were made mandatory by several state governments to furnish at airports and state borders. People began to forge their names and dates via apps such as Adobe Photoshop instead of taking an RT-PCR test, voiding the benefits from such a policy intervention.[16] QR-coded certificates would eliminate the stymieing arising out of similar mischief in vaccine certificates.

Many countries around the world which had begun vaccination drives had created their own systems which could keep track of vaccinated individuals as against vaccine stock availability while also be able to provide proof of vaccination. As economic activities and international travel would increase when the world emerged out of the pandemic, it would become imperative for individuals to show proof of vaccination. For this purpose, the international community had begun to consider the idea of a ‘vaccine passport’—a document which contained an individual’s full record of vaccination. Such an idea seemed great in theory if all countries had equitable access to vaccines. However, when put in practice, it would be hugely discriminatory to smaller nations which weren’t able to get hold of enough vaccines for even their frontline workers. Several months later, during the 47th G7 summit (11–13 June 2021), when the vaccine passport idea was discussed, India’s official stand was to oppose such a mechanism, as it would promote further inequality between the wealthier and poorer nations.[17] However, while our official stand was opposed to using a vaccine passport, if proof of vaccination became mandatory to be able to undertake international travel, a QR-coded proof of vaccination for Indians would